

Q1 2025 UPDATE

TowerXchange's Middle East and North Africa guide

A country-by-country guide to the
MENA tower industry



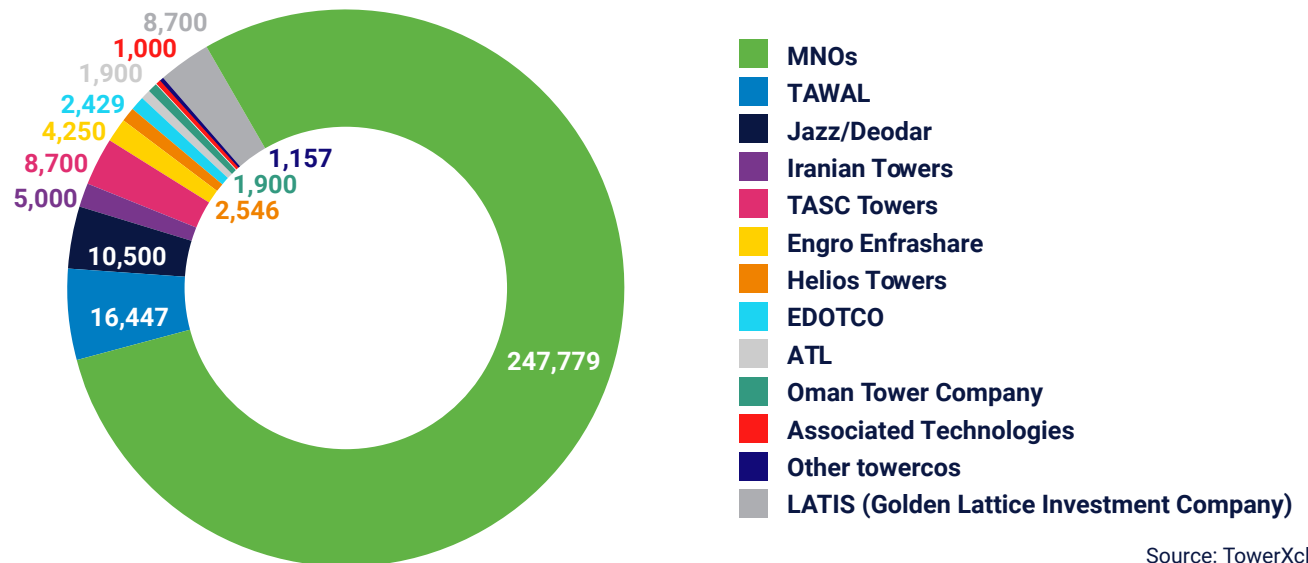


Introduction

The telecom tower industry in the Middle East and North Africa (MENA) region is in the midst of substantial change, driven by significant developments such as Zain Group's acquisition of the remaining 70% of IHS Kuwait and the Jazz-Engro partnership in Pakistan. Zain's recent transaction, valued at US\$134 million for the remaining stake in IHS Kuwait, strengthens its position in the Kuwaiti market and continues a trend of consolidation within the region. The deal follows Zain's ongoing efforts to merge its assets with Ooredoo under TASC Towers, a move that could reshape the Kuwaiti telecom infrastructure landscape by creating a combined entity managing roughly 3,889 sites. This transaction exemplifies the growing importance of infrastructure sharing and consolidation across the MENA region, where both tower companies (towercos) and mobile network operators (MNOs) are seeking to enhance efficiency and reduce operational costs.

IHS Towers' decision to exit Kuwait, despite its pioneering role in launching the sale-and-leaseback model in the region, highlights the financial challenges towercos face, especially those with high debt levels. The company's pullout is part of a broader strategic review aimed at driving shareholder value and reducing leverage, showcasing the difficulties some towercos encounter in maintaining profitability. IHS Kuwait's

Figure 1: Estimated ownership of MENA's 300,469 towers



Source: TowerXchange

towers were acquired by Zain at a 14.2x EBITDA multiple, reflecting the strong demand for telecom infrastructure but also the cautious approach towercos like IHS are taking in balancing growth with financial stability. In contrast, Helios Towers has demonstrated resilience, bolstered by its acquisition of Omantel's tower assets, which helped it maintain solid financial performance. This contrast between IHS Towers' financial pressures and Helios Towers' stability in Oman

serves as a cautionary tale for the towerco sector in MENA, particularly as more players look to consolidate their positions.

Saudi Arabia has emerged as a critical market for telecom tower consolidation. The merger of TAWAL, the infrastructure arm of STC, with LATIS will create a major player in the regional telecom infrastructure landscape, managing nearly 30,000 towers across an international



INTRODUCTION

footprint. This merger, supported by the Saudi Public Investment Fund (PIF), aligns with the kingdom's broader ambitions for its smart city projects, such as NEOM, and other mega-projects, setting Saudi Arabia apart from the rest of the region. Additionally, Mobily is exploring a potential sale of its tower assets, further contributing to the ongoing consolidation in the Saudi tower market. Should Mobily proceed with the sale, the likely buyer would be PIF, which is in the process of restructuring the country's telecom infrastructure to streamline operations and increase efficiency.

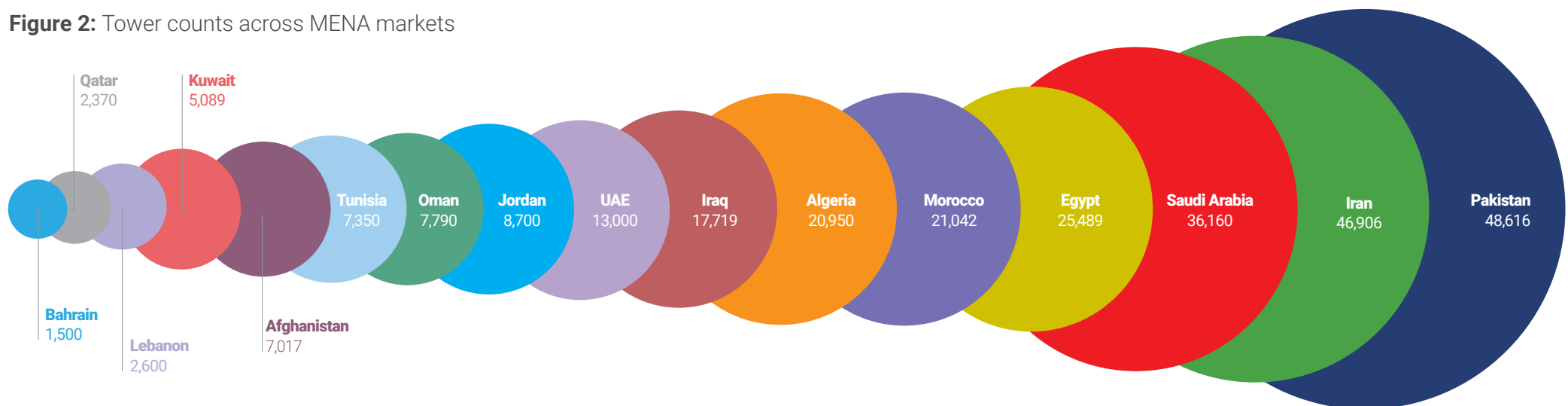
Meanwhile, Pakistan is experiencing significant developments in its telecom tower market. The Jazz-

Engro deal marks a pivotal moment in the country's telecommunications landscape, with Jazz, Pakistan's leading digital operator under VEON, joining forces with Engro Connect to optimise the management and usage of telecom infrastructure nationwide. The partnership is framed within a legal scheme of arrangement and regulatory requirements, integrating Jazz's infrastructure arm, Deodar (Private) Limited, with Engro Connect. This collaboration is expected to drive long-term benefits for both companies, allowing Jazz to continue leasing Deodar's extensive infrastructure while maintaining its focus on core digital services such as fintech, entertainment, and cloud solutions. Jazz's shift to an asset-light model is part of its broader strategy to streamline operations and focus on high-growth digital

sectors, with the partnership expected to strengthen the company's ability to provide seamless connectivity and digital services to millions of Pakistanis. For Engro Connect, the deal represents a significant step in supporting Pakistan's telecom ecosystem by providing cost-effective infrastructure solutions, which will ultimately drive progress and affordable connectivity across the nation.

Pakistan's telecom market has seen slower build-to-suit (BTS) growth in 2023 due to macroeconomic volatility, supply chain challenges, and import restrictions. However, towercos have deployed around 10,000 sites over the past five years and expect to roll out another 10,000 to 15,000 in the coming five years. Additionally,

Figure 2: Tower counts across MENA markets



Source: TowerXchange



INTRODUCTION

the completion of e& and PTCL's acquisition of Telenor and its consolidation with Ufone is expected to drive up the market's low ARPU, creating a more stable investment environment. Jazz's failed attempt to sell Deodar to TASC Towers reflects the complexity of Pakistan's market, where MNO consolidation and towerco consolidation are still ongoing, but the deal with Engro marks a positive step towards long-term stability and growth.

Across the MENA region, other MNOs are also reassessing their infrastructure strategies. Orange had been reviewing its tower assets across 14 markets in the Middle East and Africa, but unclear regulations and high tax rates have made large-scale carve-outs difficult. However, there are still opportunities for joint ventures and selective carve-outs, with Orange reportedly in talks with Vodacom and Vodafone regarding potential infrastructure-sharing partnerships. Similarly, e& (formerly Etisalat) has been working on a tower strategy, but the group's complex joint-venture structure across markets like Pakistan, Egypt, and Morocco makes it challenging to formulate a cohesive regional approach. A spokesman for e& noted that no major developments are expected in the next 12 to 18 months, but the group remains focused on optimising its tower infrastructure.

Telecom Egypt is also exploring the sale of its 2,500 towers, with bids ranging between US\$150 and US\$250 million. This sale, which could include a build-to-suit

commitment of 1,500 to 2,000 sites, was initially expected to be finalised by Q1 2024, though discussions are still ongoing. Vodafone Egypt, which was recently transferred to Vodacom Group, is also in the early stages of a potential tower carve-out, mirroring its South African strategy of forming operator-owned infrastructure services under MAST Services.

The MENA region's tower industry is seeing accelerated growth and transformation, with many MNOs opting for towerco partnerships to drive efficiency and value creation. The TASC Towers merger with Ooredoo is expected to take 12 to 18 months to complete, with Ooredoo's 20,000 towers being handed over in phases. It remains unclear when Zain's towers in markets like Bahrain, Sudan, and South Sudan—where progress is delayed due to conflict—will be included in the handover. These developments underscore the rapid evolution of the region's telecom infrastructure landscape, where state involvement, operator balance sheets, and collaboration between MNOs and towercos are driving a wave of consolidation and innovation.



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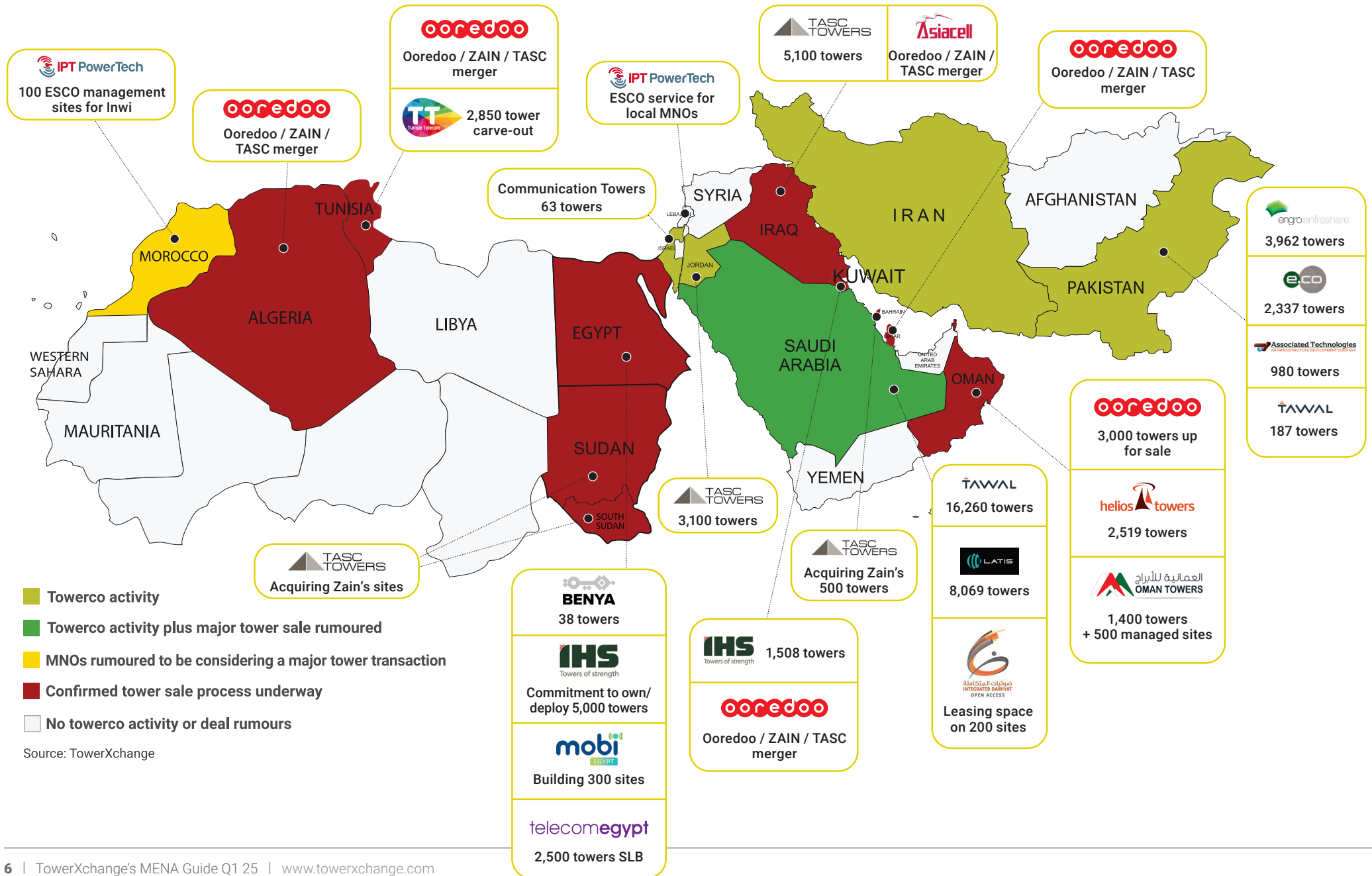
Figure 3: Footprints of MENA's major MNOs

	e&	Ooredoo	Orange	STC	Vodafone	Zain
Afghanistan						
Algeria						
Bahrain						
Egypt						
Iran						
Iraq						
Jordan						
Kuwait						
Lebanon						
Libya						
Morocco						
Oman						
Palestine						
Pakistan						
Qatar						
Saudi Arabia						
Syria						
Tunisia						
UAE						
Yemen						

n.b. Lighter colours indicate the company owning a stake in an MNO in the country

Source: TowerXchange

Figure 4: Heatmap of tower deals and towerco activity in MENA





Afghanistan



Towers (2021*):
7,017



Population (2021*):
42.2mn



Subscribers (2021*):
22.7mn

SIMs per tower (2021*): 3,282 **SIM penetration (2021*):** 58%

Urban / rural population split (%): 73.1 / 26.9

MNOs (2021*): Afghan Telecom Afghan Wireless, Etisalat, M1 Group, Roshan

Towerco activity (2021*): Asia Consultancy Group

*activities and statistics not updated since fall of Kabul.

This has unsurprisingly impacted the telecoms sector, which is sitting near the bottom of the world's telecom market maturity ranking. Despite the previous administrations attempts to improve network coverage, Taliban rule risks undoing this development.

Afghanistan has five MNOs, Afghan Wireless (AWCC) which was the country's fastest growing MNO, Roshan which is funded by the Aga Khan Development Fund and was the country's largest MNO, multi-national player Etisalat, and newcomer Afghan Telecom which is part of the Ministry of Communications and Information Technology.

MTN has completed the sale of its Afghan business unit to Beirut-based holding company M1 New Ventures for US\$35mn, although this was expected to finalise by the end of 2023. This completes the operator's regional strategy of exiting the Middle East to focus on their core African markets having previously exited Yemen and Syria.

Each of the operators own almost all of their sites, with the MNOs understood to have between 1,000-1,500 towers each. The Telecom Regulatory Authority of Afghanistan (ATRA) website is no longer available but in 2021 it counted 6,917 base stations in the country.

Asia Consultancy Group is the country's sole towerco and owns around 100 towers which it makes available for co-location and RAN sharing services.

The deteriorating security situation and Taliban demands to shutdown sites to avoid surveillance stymied investment. Since the takeover and Afghanistan's exit from international markets all investment has frozen and the focus is on keeping sites operational so that Afghanistan's remaining subscribers can access services. No accurate count of active SIMs was available.

99% of sites run on gensets – even in cities – and the biggest challenge is getting fuel delivered to sites. Solar solutions had been examined but the payback period means that MNOs have been reluctant to invest.

There are few to no major international contractors operating in the market, and TowerXchange understands that mobile operators are having difficulty paying suppliers.

The Afghanistan Telecom Regulatory Authority (ATRA) is still seeking to expand mobile coverage, with plans for new mobile sites in Paktika province, according to Pajhwok Afghan News. However, TowerXchange is aware of no appetite for outside investment in the market.

The World Bank's recent development update shows that Afghanistan continues to deteriorate. Since the Taliban takeover the economy has contracted for two consecutive years with real GDP growth falling from around 10% in 2019 to -5% in 2022. Despite a sharp decline in inflation improving household good prices, monetary poverty still affects over half the population.



Algeria

Towers:
20,950

Population:
43.9mn

Subscribers:
45.6mn

SIMs per tower: 2,354 **SIM penetration:** 104%

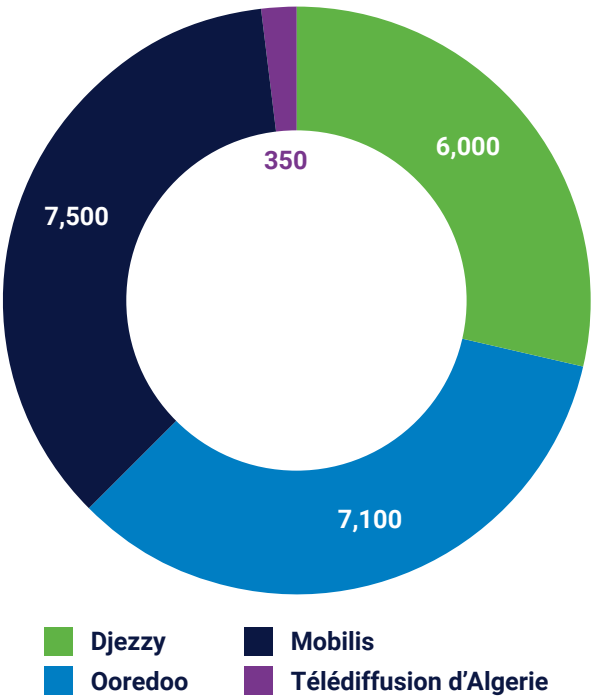
Urban / rural population split (%): 75 / 25

MNOs: Djezzy (Fonds National d'Investissement), Mobilis (Algerie Telecom), Ooredoo (Wataniya Telecom Algerie)

Towerco activity: TASC Towers (pending Ooredoo acquisition), Télédiffusion d'Algerie (TDA)

Algeria’s economy has been growing but remains exposed. Growth is expected to recover in 2024, with GDP rebounding from a 5% decline in 2020 but has not yet fully recovered to pre-pandemic levels. Investment growth is expected to remain robust while inflation declines gradually in 2024-25, but a reliance on volatile hydrocarbon exports has impacted the Algerian Dinar which has a –1.7 average annual depreciation vs the US\$. There are an estimated tower count towers in the country

Figure 5: Algeria – estimated tower count



Source: TowerXchange

of which 20% are ground based and the rest are rooftop or alternative site typologies. Mobilis has the largest portfolio with around 7,500 sites, followed by Djezzy with 6,500 and Ooredoo with 7,100. State owned broadcaster, Télédiffusion d'Algerie (TDA) has 350 towers.

All MNOs have good 3G reach at around 92% for 3G, but competition for the 4G market is driving demand for additional network capacity. Djezzy leads the market with 80%, followed by Ooredoo at 75.6% and Mobilis with 68.6%. With many sites lacking the structural capacity for multiple tenants and MNOs failing to agree site sharing swaps, less than 2% of sites are currently shared.Regulators have been unpredictable; active sharing policy in 2016 saw Ooredoo and Djezzy colocating on around 1,000 sites before the policy was reversed, only to start asking for overlapping sites to be decommissioned more recently. The Algerian government is now prioritising national 4G LTE with Djezzy investing heavily in 3/4G network expansion as well as testing 5G in partnership with Huawei and Nokia. A commercial 5G launch has been in the works since 2022 but has yet to launch. Ooredoo however has tasked Nokia with preparing its network to be 5G-ready.

TASC Towers is in the process of acquiring Ooredoo Algeria’s 7,100 towers as part of the regional Ooredoo/ Zain/TASC merger. As a first-mover, numerous regulatory hurdles will need to be cleared before the deal completes. But once finalised, TASC Towers is left in a strong position to further consolidate the market and will be incentivized to as Ooredoo’s current tenancy ratio sits at just 1.01x. In terms of site operations, 99% of sites are on grid with generators used for backup on core sites.



Bahrain



Towers:
1,500



Population:
1.49mn



Subscribers:
1.7mn

SIMs per tower: 1,133

SIM penetration: 100%

Urban / rural population split (%): 89.9 / 10.1

MNOs: Batelco, stc, Zain

Towerco activity: TASC Towers (pending closure of Zain deal)

After closing the acquisition of Zain's towers in Iraq, Bahrain was next on the list for TASC Towers to close as part of their regional sale leaseback with the operator.

Originally due to close in H1 of 2023, the Ooredoo acquisition announcement has no doubt slowed down progress, although the handover is still expected to happen this year. TASCs entrance will mark the first independent towerco activity in the country, and closely aligns with the TRAs long-term goal of consolidating the MNO's three tower networks.

Bahrain is a leading global ICT hub, ranking 4th globally in the Telecommunication Infrastructure Index and achieving the first position in the Arab world on the ICT Development Index. This is thanks to several government initiatives to drive ICT development, most notably Economic Vision 2030.

The Kingdom has built a substantial national 5G network with Batelco, Zain and stc all having launched commercial 5G and invested heavily in wireless and fibre infrastructure.

This has helped the Kingdom build a strong digital sector supporting technology-driven businesses and seen 5G use-cases such as Bahrain airport's advanced IoT private network.

While Bahrain has a reliable energy grid, concerns over sustainability and increasing power consumption of 5G is driving MNOs to explore renewable and energy efficiency solutions. Zain has partnered with Rental Solutions & Services becoming Bahrain's first MNO to deploy on-site hybrid solar and battery solutions to reduce its carbon footprint.

As the network expands to new areas outside the national grid and increases energy demands from 5G, Zain plans to install more on-site renewable solutions to its towers in line with their environmental sustainability strategy. It is likely that TASC Towers, who is providing energy-as-a-service after taking over Zain's tower and power infrastructure in Iraq, will also take over power provision in Bahrain as well.

The Kingdom of Bahrain has three mobile network operators; Batelco, Saudi Telecom Company-owned Viva and Zain. Despite its small landmass Bahrain has 1,500 sites of which around 20% are shared.

Tower deployments in Bahrain have been strictly controlled by the Telecoms Regulatory Authority (TRA), who's Public Radio Communications Stations Regulation (PRS Regulation) introduced in 2018 set out a goal of increasing the percentage of site sharing from 12% to 40% by 2033.



Egypt



Towers:
25,489



Population:
112.7mn



Subscribers:
95.4mn

SIMs per tower: 3,818

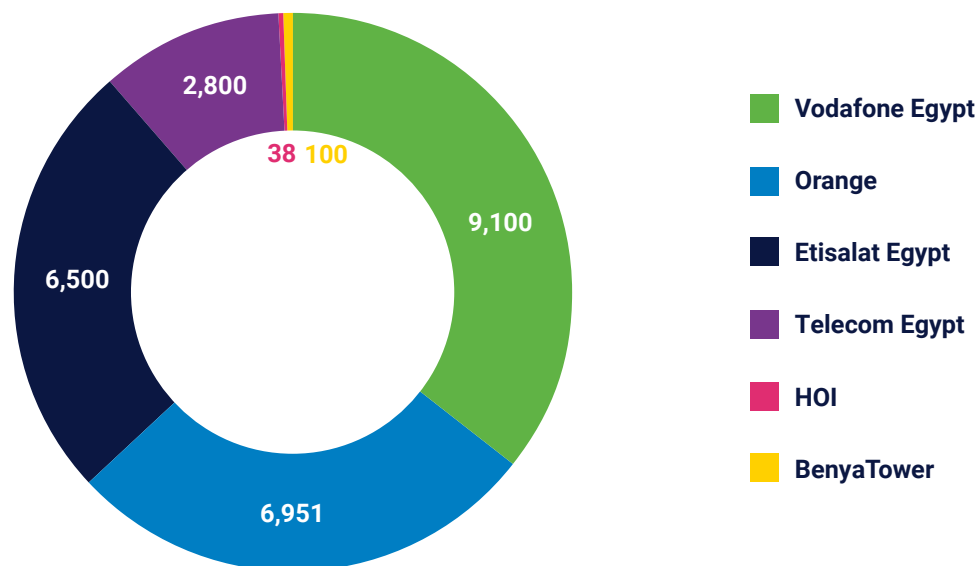
SIM penetration: 93%

Urban / rural population split (%): 43.1 / 56.9

MNOs: Etisalat, Orange, Vodafone, Telecom Egypt

Towerco activity: HOI, IHS Towers, BenyaTower

Figure 6: Egypt – estimated tower count



Source: TowerXchange

Egypt has suffered economic turmoil since the Ukraine war led to cost-of-living spikes, including access to fuel. With fuel subsidies putting a huge burden on the government's finances, state-owned assets are being sold off to mitigate this. The government has raised US\$121mn selling a 9.5% stake in Telecom Egypt with most shares sold to local investors as part of a broader plan to sell US\$2 billion of state assets. This is likely a driver for Telecom Egypt's sale, as the MNO is asking to be paid in US\$.

While the economy is stabilising, the devaluation of the Egyptian pound has resulted in significant cost increases to deploying and maintaining tower networks, and towercos have started negotiations to adjust prices. However, with a large population and shortage of telecom infrastructure there is plenty of opportunity for growth. The government has also taken notice of the underinvested telecommunications infrastructure sector and has launched projects such as the Hayah Karima initiative to address this.

There has been some action from towercos as ICT Infrastructure provider Benya Group has acquired licensed towerco MobiTower, rebranding to BenyaTower, and is currently executing the governments 'Hayah Karima' initiative, a tower-sharing project overseen by the NTRA deploying 300 towers by the end of 2023.

Telecom Egypt is in talks for the sale of 2,500 of its 2,800-tower portfolio, with bids ranging from US\$150-



EGYPT

250mn, putting a per-tower valuation at US\$60-100,000. These sites are understood to be 50% ground-based and 50% rooftop, with most in urban areas. The deal is also understood to include a build-to-suit commitment of 1,500 – 2,000 sites. A transaction was originally dated to finalise in Q1 2024, but no deal has yet materialized.

After Vodafone transferred its 55% stake in Vodafone Egypt to its African subsidiary Vodacom, the MNO is preparing for a carve-out to its new operator-owned towerco MAST Services, which launched in 2023 after taking over the operators 8,600 tower portfolio in South

Africa. However, this is understood to be at the early planning stages, and no public information has come to light yet.

With MNOs still owning most of the tower infrastructure new tower deployments are operator-led, as Telecom Egypt is rollout out 1000s of new sites including ground-based, rooftops and inbuilding solutions and Etisalat Egypt investing US\$270mn in network expansion.

A big driver of this is the NTRA's push to ensure national 4G coverage, having accepting Telecom Egypt's offer for

additional spectrum to manage increasing capacity and coverage, as well as fund 5G rollout after the MNO secured a 5G license for US\$150mn. Telecom Egypt is aiming to have 50% of its network 5G ready with a targeted rollout. Orange was allocated 5G spectrum back in 2022 with Ericsson since preparing their network.

In 2021 IHS Towers was awarded a 15-year towerco licensed as part of a revised NTRA framework, with the condition it reaches 5,800 new sites through sale leaseback and build-to-suit. However, there has been little progress in achieving this target so far.



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Iran



Towers:
46,906



Population:
89.2mn



Subscribers:
127.6mn

SIMs per tower: 3,104

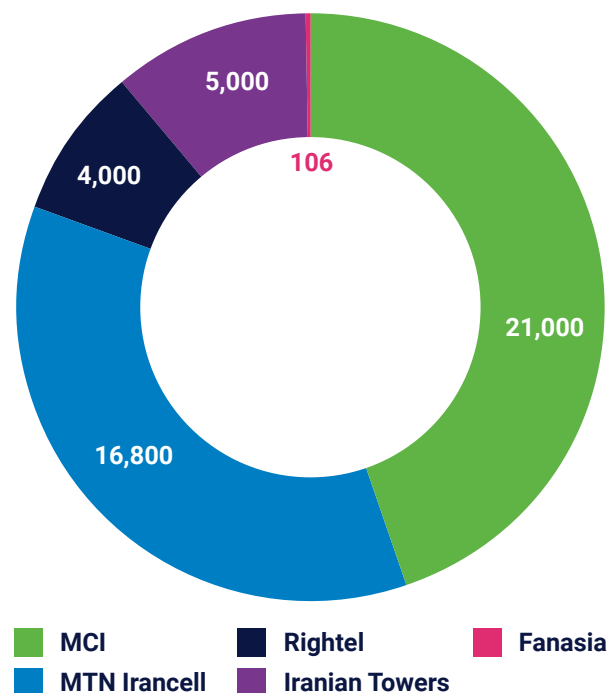
SIM penetration: 152%

Urban / rural population split (%): 77.3 / 22.7

MNOs: MCI, MTN-Irancell, RighTel

Towerco activity: Iranian Towers and Fanasia

Figure 7: Iran – estimated tower count



Source: TowerXchange

Due to ongoing trade sanctions and contact restrictions, TowerXchange has faced challenges in directly sourcing or verifying tower counts in Iran. Despite these limitations, efforts continue to gather accurate information on the country's tower infrastructure.

Iran is the Middle East's largest mobile market with 127.6mn subscribers. There are three national operators in the country of which MCI (Mobile Communication Company of Iran) is the largest with 61.3mn subscribers and 43% of the market share. MTN-Irancell, a joint

venture in which MTN holds a 49% stake, is Iran's second largest operator and has invested over US\$10bn in its network since launching in 2006 reaching 82% national 4G coverage and 5% 4G coverage. MTN Irancell is also working towards an IPO which is expected to be

concluded in 2024 as there was a requirement under Irancell's concession that the owner would divest a 21% stake via an IPO within 3 years of service launch back in 2016. So far, the government has been unable to facilitate an IPO.

RighTel is the third largest operator with 9.5mn subscribers and around 8-9% market share. In addition to this there are a number of FCP players and WiMAX operators who make up the balance of the market share. In 2021 MCI has been rolling out 5G services since 2021, reaching the northern Kurdish region last year. There are currently around 47,000 towers in the Iranian market and with very little infrastructure sharing between the operators there is a significant degree of parallel infrastructure. In 2014, Fanasia, an Iranian company with a background as a turnkey service provider to the country's MNOs, started their own towerco business.

Iranian Towers was launched in 2017 in response to increasing infrastructure sharing in Iran and is jointly owned by the country's three MNOs. Iranian Towers has been rolling out 4G networks in predominantly urban areas in coordination with local municipalities who benefit from revenue sharing on these sites. TowerXchange's last recorded tower count for Iranian towers was around 5,000 with an additional leasing deal with MTN-Irancell and build-



IRAN

to-suit program with MCI but has not been able to provide an updated figure due to contact restrictions.



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Iraq



Towers:
17,719



Population:
45.5mn



Subscribers:
36.9mn

SIMs per tower: 2,496

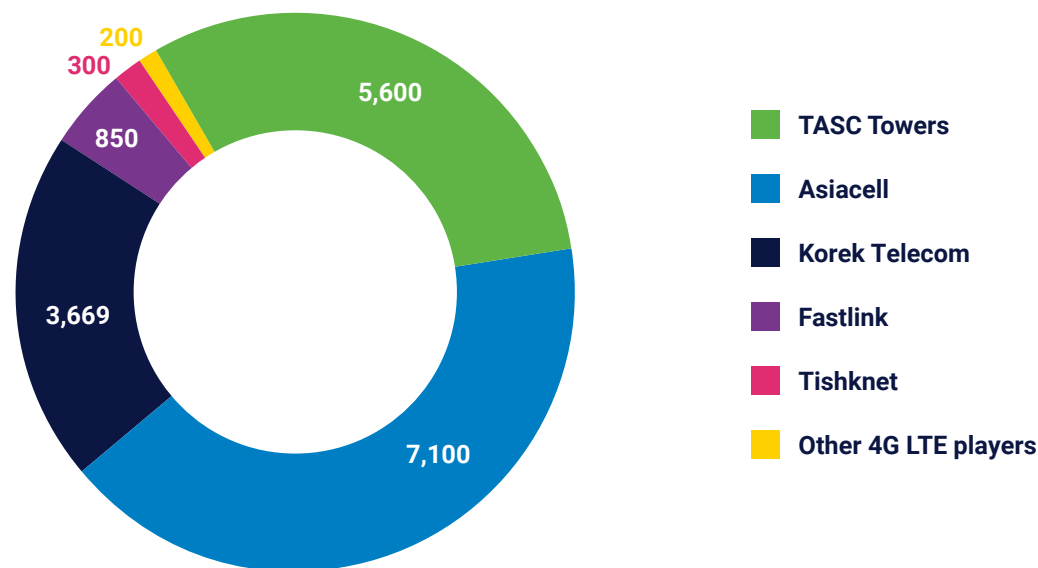
SIM penetration: 92%

Urban / rural population split (%): 71.6 / 28.4

MNOs: Asiacell (Ooredoo), Korek Telecom, Zain, Fastlink, Tishknet, Goran-Net, Mobitel

Towerco activity: TASC Towers, IQ Networks

Figure 8: Iraq – estimated tower count



Source: TowerXchange

Iraq is experiencing a period of relative stability following years of political turbulence, with Fitch recently reaffirming the country's IDR at B- with a stable outlook. Despite this, challenges remain, including a weak government, rising domestic tensions ahead of the 2025 elections, and a heavy dependence on declining oil export prices, all of which heighten risks. GDP growth has slowed, dropping from 7% in 2022 to 2.5% YoY in Q1 2023, though inflation remains

low at 3.7%. Additionally, US restrictions on the flow of dollars through Iraq to sanctioned neighbouring countries have contributed to an average annual depreciation of 3.2% for the Iraqi dinar against the US dollar.

Iraq has three nationwide MNOs; Zain, Asiacell (owned by Ooredoo) and Korek Telecom. Zain has the largest mobile market share, with Asiacell close behind,

whilst Korek Telecom is the country's fastest growing operator which is dominant in the Kurdistan region.

TASC Towers operates 4,968 towers including an additional 300 managed sensitive sites acquired from Zain, and is targeting 300-450 greenfield tower deployments per year, although the priority is in upgrading existing sites. Consolidation is hot on the heels of TASC's Zain acquisition, with Asiacell's 7,100



IRAQ

towers in the process of transferring ownership to TASC after the completion of the merge Ooredoo and Zain's sites under TASC Towers. Despite low tenancy ratios of close to 1.0x for Zain and Ooredoo sites, this number is expected to increase over time as TASC decommission overlapping sites and drive-up colocations.

Assuming regulatory approvals run smoothly TASC will become the dominant tower owner in Iraq, operating around 70% of the country's towers. Korek Telecom has been in the process of reviewing its passive infrastructure for some time but has yet to make a clear decision. The MNO has found itself in hot waters recently, having its connection suspended after failing to pay US\$800mn in taxes and licensing fees. While this doesn't bode well for the operator, a sale of its passive infrastructure could be a way to raise the needed capital.

In addition to the three nationwide operators, there are a host of 4G LTE players in the Kurdistan region, Fastlink being the largest with Tishknet, Goran-Net and Mobitel amongst the other players.

In October 2023 Iraq announced plans to introduce a 5G license with Al-Salam Telecommunications Company granted license to manage the new network and is inviting global firms to bid for installation and operation. However, 4G remains a priority for MNOs after Korek launched services in 2021.

Although new build-to-suit rollouts have been limited compared to previous years with Korek reporting a drop from 1,000s to 100s, MNOs are looking at upgrading the existing network and increasing capacity. This includes antenna organisation, fibre-to-site rollout and data centres to improve quality of service.

Iraq's MNOs are struggling with high opex, attributable in large part to security and logistics issues across the country. Power remains a major challenge and while figures for power availability vary by region and by time of year (with 11-12 hours outages per day being normal). Most sites are reliant on two diesel generators and so TASC Towers has live RFPs out for almost all aspects of O&M; batteries, solar PV, hybrid solutions, RMS and maintenance vendors. Hybrid solutions are yet to have any large-scale trials in the country but MNOs have started to look at alternative energy solutions to move away from the costly and difficult logistics of diesel energy. Asiacell has been rolling out rural sites using solar power.

Local ISP IQ Networks is Iraq's major fibre deployer with over 10,000km laid. IQ is transitioning into the broader connectivity space, operating three colocation datacentres and is building a tower pilot on 100 sites. While IQ do not yet operate any towers, their executive team has informed TowerXchange their appetite to acquire tower infrastructure.



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Jordan

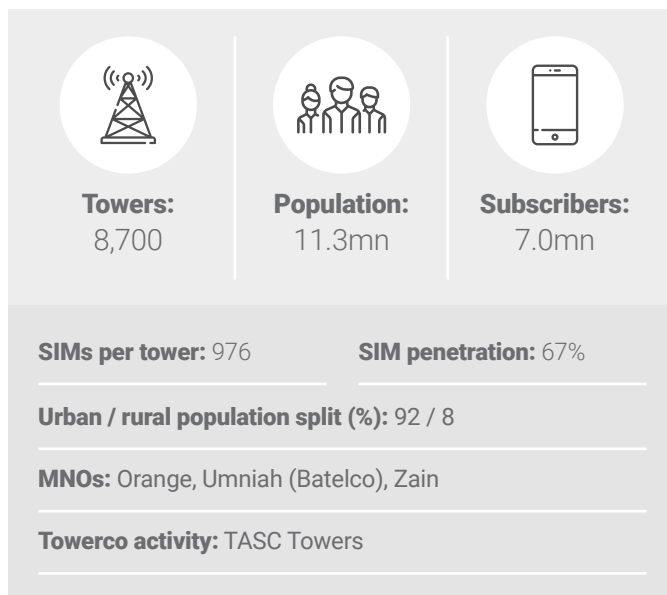
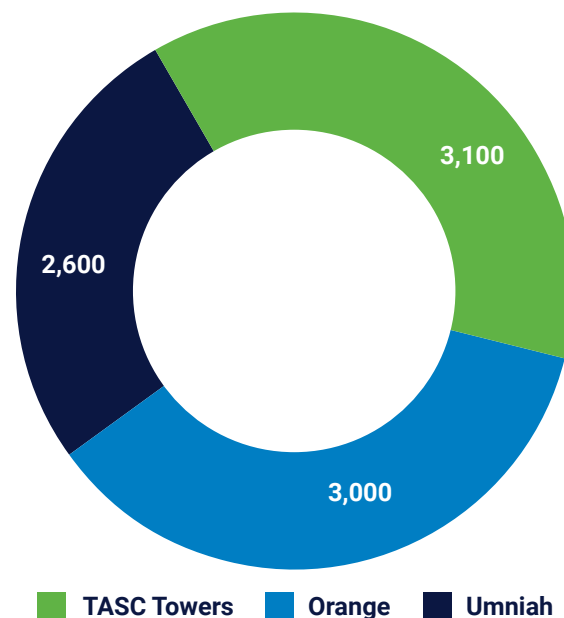


Figure 9: Jordan – estimated tower count



Source: TowerXchange

Umniah (owned by Batelco). Zain leads the market with a 43% share followed by Orange at 29% and Umniah at 28%. TASC Towers is the only towerco in Jordan, acquiring Zain's portfolio at the start of 2022. TASC Towers is managing all of Zain's old sites as well as a build-to-suit rollout of 525 sites over the next 5 years and energy management services. The towerco is

focused on rapid colocations to increase their near 1x tenancy ratio as well as exploring non-macro small cells, DAS and street furniture deployments for urban and indoor coverage.

Infrastructure sharing is low as TASC mostly serves Zain on single-tenant sites, but the towerco has made strides in taking over network rollouts for two of the three MNOs in Jordan reflecting a change in mindset from local operators. With the telecoms sector exposed to heavy taxes and high opex including rising energy costs, colocation is becoming an increasingly more popular option for operators to meet growing network expansion demands.

Jordan is well underway in its 5G rollout with Orange and Umniah rolling out commercial networks having received licenses 5% year-on-year until reaching 75% while Zain lags behind but is getting its network 5G-ready. Nearly all TASC sites are being upgraded to 5G and expects to have 97% 5G coverage across their network. TASC expect to achieve a tenancy ratio of 1.3x due to colocations as well as 1.7x energy increase, but Orange expects this to be as high as 3x. To mitigate this, TASC is hybridising sites incorporating solar and battery backup as well as smart energy management systems, while Orange has been using energy wheeling from solar farms connected to the grid.

Jordan's economic trajectory has proven resilient, as the country persists at a stable 2.5% GDP growth in late 2023 and a deceleration in headline inflation to an expected 2.4%. The US-pegged Jordanian Dinar also limits currency risks helping create stability for foreign and domestic investment. Jordan's greatest risk may come from its border with Israel-Palestine, but it's politically neutral stance in regional conflicts has helped the country navigate instability in the past.

There are three MNOs in Jordan; Orange, Zain and



Kuwait

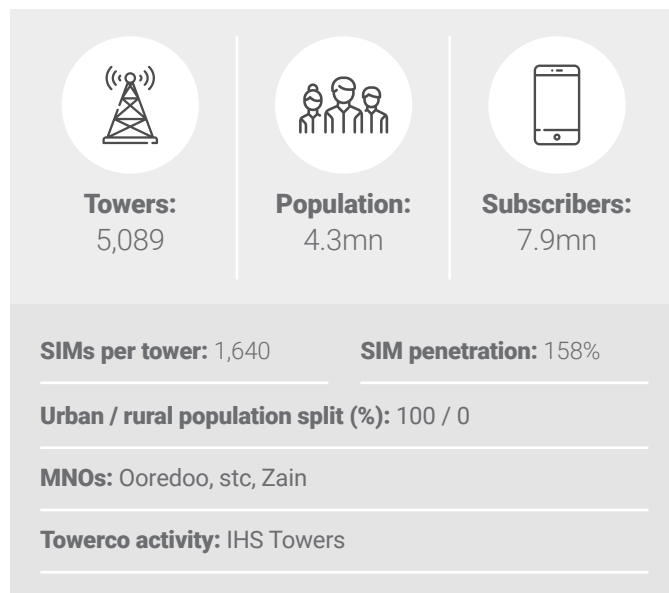
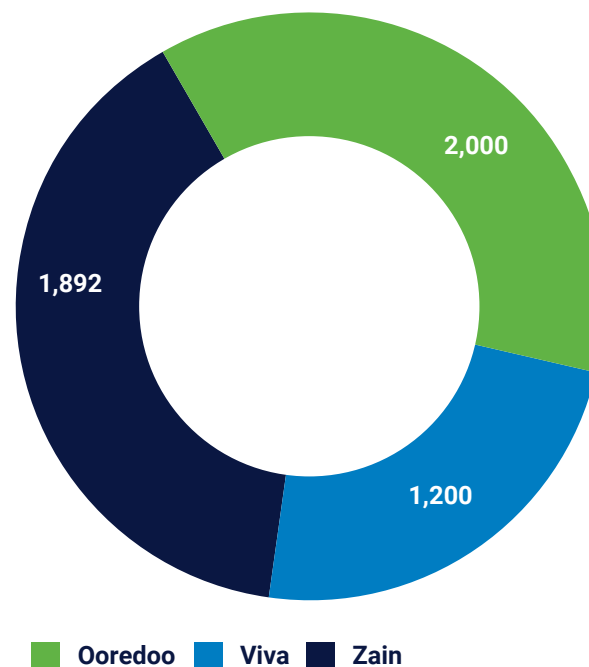


Figure 10: Kuwait – estimated tower count



Source: TowerXchange

an operator to a pureplay independent and remains the only towerco in the country.

The 'New Kuwait' country strategy growing investments in ICT to US\$11bn by 2024 will be

primarily driven by 5G-related use-cases, as the country has achieved 97% 5G coverage. However, only 14% of the population use 5G, meaning there is significant growth downstream as the connectivity infrastructure has been mostly rolled out. Following this will be a period of network densification to support higher capacity networks, with IHS having previously explored small cells as a use-case. Analysys Mason estimates that 5G will drive a cumulative increase of over US\$1bn in Kuwait's GDP by 2025, while Future Market Insights suggest the global B2B telecom market is set to each US\$107bn by 2025.

Ooredoo's 1,200 tower portfolio is part of the ongoing regional handover of the MNO's regional tower portfolio to TASC Towers, of which the operator now owns 49.3%. The whole process is expected to take around 24 months to complete, although there are still several regulatory hurdles to overcome in each market. However, Kuwaiti regulatory authority CITRA has been introducing regulation to encourage infrastructure sharing and is supportive of colocating infrastructure.

Kuwait has an extensive energy grid with 86% of IHS sites reportedly connected to the grid. All sites have generator backup with full on-site custom power installations for off-grid of specific sites. However, the towerco is exploring



KUWAIT

energy management systems to help drive network optimisation and enhance energy efficiency. CITRA has been introducing regulation to encourage infrastructure sharing and is supportive of colocating infrastructure.

In a significant development for Kuwait's telecom industry, Zain Group has signed a deal to acquire the remaining 70% of IHS Kuwait from IHS Towers, valuing the business at US\$230 million with an implied Adjusted EBITDA multiple of 14.2x. This deal follows the 2019 sale and leaseback agreement, when Zain sold a majority stake in its tower assets to IHS for US\$165 million while retaining

a 30% share. With this acquisition, Zain will own 100% of IHS Kuwait Limited, which operates 1,675 towers and manages an additional 700 sites for other owners. This move is part of Zain's strategy to integrate its infrastructure assets into a regional towerco, particularly in light of the TASC Towers-Ooredoo-Zain merger timeline, which will consolidate approximately 30,000 towers across MENA. The transaction, expected to close in the first half of 2025, will enhance Zain's ability to provide independent tower infrastructure services in Kuwait, potentially combining with Ooredoo's sites after their transfer to TASC Towers in H2 2025. Meanwhile, IHS Towers' exit from Kuwait reflects the

company's ongoing efforts to reduce debt and optimise shareholder value, contrasting with the financial stability observed in Helios Towers' operations in Oman.



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Lebanon



Towers:
2,600



Population:
5.4mn



Subscribers:
4.3mn

SIMs per tower: 1,654

SIM penetration: 63%

Urban / rural population split (%): 89.4 / 10.6

MNOs: Alfa, touch

Towerco activity: None

ESCOs: IPT PowerTech

Lebanon continues to suffer from economic and political crisis, both internally and externally, as the neighbouring conflict in Israel risks escalation amid border tensions. Lebanon's economic contraction has narrowed since 2022 with signs of private sector stabilisation, helping the exchange rate. Economic growth had for the first time projected to increase by 0.2% pre-October 2023, but inflation is projected to accelerate to 231% due to ongoing macroeconomic deterioration. With the onset of the current conflict, Lebanon's economy is projected to fall back into recession.

There are two state owned MNOs in Lebanon, touch and Alfa, both now run by the government. Zain Group and Orascom, respectively, previously had management contracts but both reverted to the government at the end of 2020.

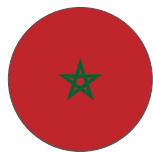
The two operators have a roughly equal market share in a country which has some of the highest mobile tariffs in the world. There are approximately 2,600 towers evenly split between the two operators, with no independent towercos operating in the country. Some telecom

infrastructure has been damaged and mobile services disrupted due to missile strikes according to Alfa.

Of the 2,600 towers, approximately 15% are on good grid with 24 hours of availability, 73-75% are on poor grid (with availability ranging from 6-18 hours) and 10-12% of sites are completely off-grid.

Signs indicate that grid quality in the country is, however, worsening. IPT PowerTech have signed ESCO contracts with both operators in the market, taking over management of power across their site portfolios. In late 2021, the Lebanese government issued an urgent warning that the telecoms sector could 'collapse' within days due to fuel shortages.

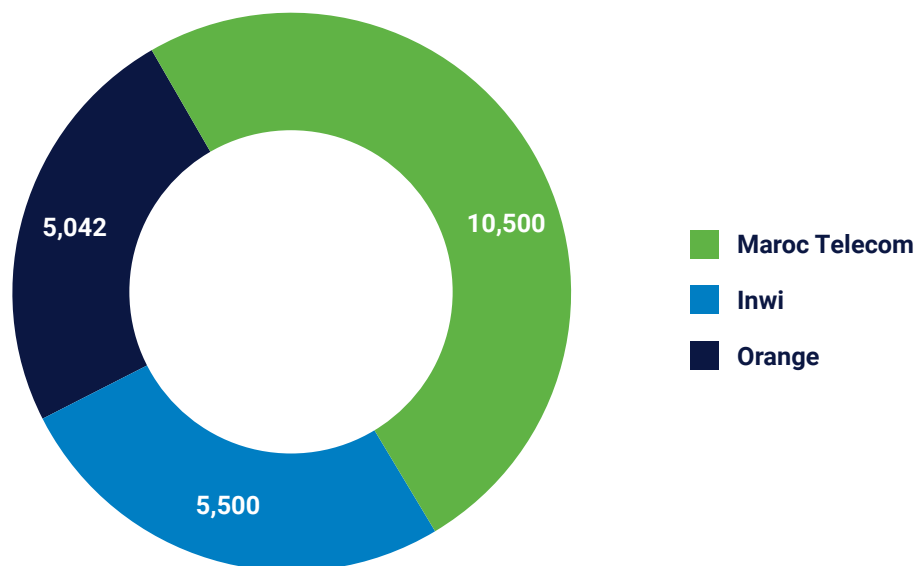
In late 2023, Lebanon secured an US\$8mn financial contribution from China for solar energy installations to address persistent electricity shortages, equipping 830 of state-owned fixed-infrastructure operator Orego's sites with solar panels.



Morocco

		
Towers: 21,042	Population: 37.8mn	Subscribers: 51.7mn
SIMs per tower: 2,337		SIM penetration: 137%
Urban / rural population split (%): 65.1 / 34.9		
MNOs: Inwi, Maroc Telecom, Orange		
Towerco activity: None		
ESCOs: IPT PowerTech		

Figure 11: Morocco– estimated tower count



Source: TowerXchange

After a sharp deceleration in economic growth in 2022, GDP has increased 2.8% in 2023 and is expected to reach 3.1% in 2024 up to 3.5% in 2026 as demand recovers from recent shocks. Inflation has also halved, but food inflation is still impacting lower income households.

Maroc Telecom is the leading MNO in the Moroccan market with 38% market share, ahead of both Inwi (in which

Zain has a 15.5% stake) and Orange in a country with 49.2mn subscribers. Data usage continues to grow as 4G rollout progresses, with Maroc Telecom reporting 4G population coverage at 93% (versus 73% in 2016). Mobile remains the main medium for high-speed internet access as last-mile fibre has yet to become commercially viable and operators prefer to invest in mobile infrastructure, spurred by rising smartphone penetration and data access.

Maroc Telecom has the largest tower portfolio with approximately 10,500 sites, whilst Orange and Inwi are understood to have around 5,000 each. Infrastructure sharing between the MNOs exists, with approximately 15% of sites thought to be shared but largely continue to operate their own network infrastructure. The Moroccan grid is generally good with IPT Powertech providing an ESCO service to 100 remote sites for Inwi.



MOROCCO

Orange has been building solar farms to inject into the grid as it's cheaper to generate their own energy and pay a transport fee than consume expensive grid energy. This model of using existing grid infrastructure to transport renewable energy from large solar farms to sites could be an effective solution for MNOs and towercos in the region to circumvent rising energy prices and help meet sustainability goals.

Maroc Telecom is closely linked with the government, and since 2019 has been investing in new communications infrastructure in the Kingdom. Under the agreement, Maroc

Telecom is investing MAD10 billion (US\$1bn) over the 2019-2021 period, focusing on deployment of mobile and fixed high-speed broadband. The government is actively promoting digital infrastructure.

The Moroccan government has shown a desire to pursue digital transformation, signing an agreement with Orange in June 2022 for US\$575.6mn in investment to enhance 4G/5G cell sites and FTTX networks. 5G is anticipated in 2022 with Orange waiting on licensing permission which could push operators to share infrastructure as a way to reduce opex and network overlap. Both Inwi and Maroc

Telecom are running 5G trials, and with Orange's 5G experience in other markets all MNOs will likely be able to launch when the market is ready.

While no tower activity has emerged yet, TowerXchange is aware of interest from several parties in launching build-to-suit services in the market. Both Maroc Telecom (through its parent company Etisalat) and Orange have worked with towercos in Africa before, and Inwi is part owned by Zain telecom which has been on a tower selling spree across its Middle Eastern markets. One to watch.



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Oman

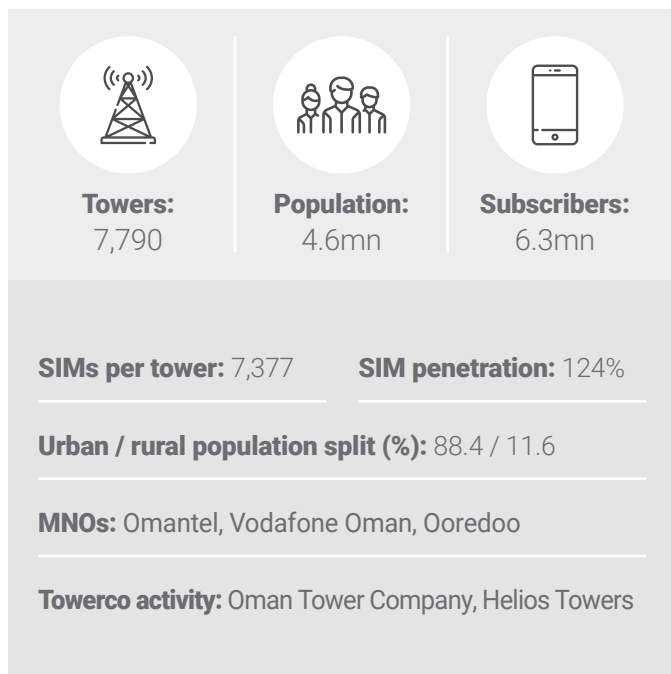
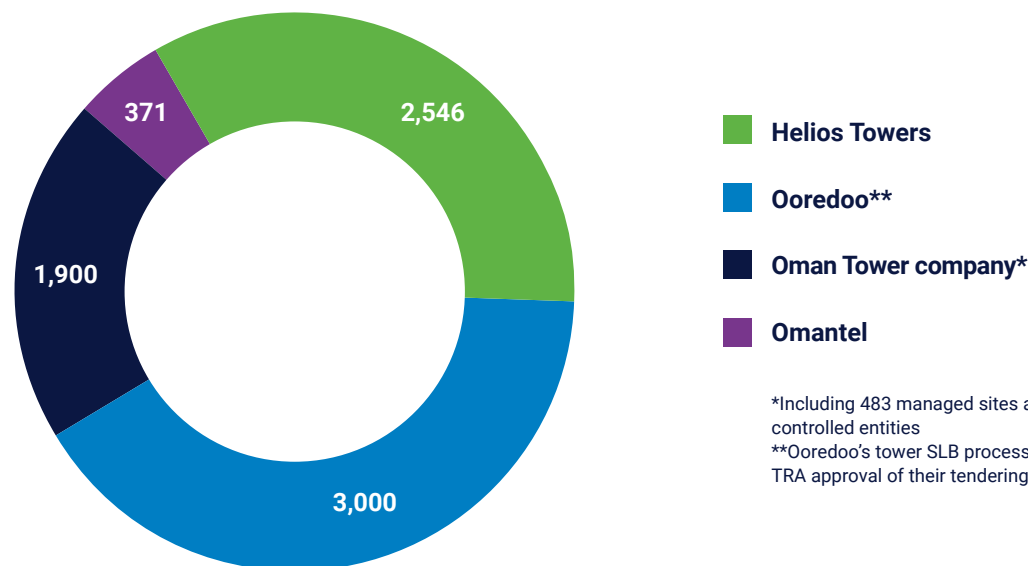


Figure 12: Oman– estimated tower count



Source: TowerXchange

Oman has three established MNOs; Omantel, Ooredoo and Vodafone, as well as two mobile resellers Renna Mobile and Friendi Mobile. Vodafone Oman, a partnership between Oman Future Telecommunications and Vodafone, launched in 2023 with roaming agreements in place with both Omantel and Ooredoo to give a national reach. Oman Tower Company is leading Vodafone Oman's network build out and has secured an additional

\$70mn in funding to drive further deployments and tenancies on their network.

Oman Tower Company was established in February 2018 by Oman 70 Holding Company, AktivCo and the Omani Government, but Camusat AktivCo has exited the company. As well as its deal with Vodafone Oman, Oman Tower Company manages 100s of government owned

sites and has a sharing agreement with local petroleum group PDO.

In December 2022, Helios Towers closed its US\$495mn deal to acquire 2,519 sites from Omantel. The deal also includes a build-to-suit commitment of a further 300 sites. The deal does not include some in-building sites and sensitive locations, but Helios Towers is in ongoing



OMAN

discussions with Oman's regulator (TRA) to expand their license to include IBS. Helios Towers have identified Oman as an opportunity to test new technologies and trial new products and services where the technology curve is more advanced including edge data centres and potentially small cells depending on how the tower licensing framework evolves.

While Ooredoo announced their merger with Zain and TASC Towers across 5 markets, their Oman portfolio was left and is part of an ongoing separate sale leaseback. While it is still early in the process and no clear timeframe has been set, the TRA has already experienced their first SLB and it is usual for subsequent deals to complete more quickly.

Infrastructure sharing has been limited, with estimates suggesting approximately 10% of towers are shared, but this has started to increase as the MNOs aim to execute the rollout of 4G more cost effectively. Vodafone Oman's network strategy is focused on colocating on existing sites with OTC and Helios Towers, helping to drive up currently low tenancy ratios of around 1.1x.

The TRA, Oman's telecoms regulatory body, has also been pushing colocations and restricting duplicate site building. Helios Towers' Q4 2023 results saw a change in group strategy towards growing tenancies to drive asset valuation and free cashflow and are looking at 10–15-meter site upgrades to create space on their mostly single-tenant network.

Both Omantel and Ooredoo have launched commercial 5G services in the country and with a new operator in the form of Vodafone Oman, co-location and new build growth prospects look good.

The TRA's recent announcement that they expect to see 100% of telecom towers supporting 4G and 5G services by the end of 2025 and coverage reaching 98% of the population, significantly more investment will be required by MNOs and towercos to meet these targets. Ooredoo reports that 94% of its sites are 4G enabled already, but newcomer Vodafone Oman will need to scale quickly to meet these targets.

The TRA is also going to be shutting down 3G networks in Q3 2024 to repurpose spectrum for more advanced 4G and 5G.



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Pakistan

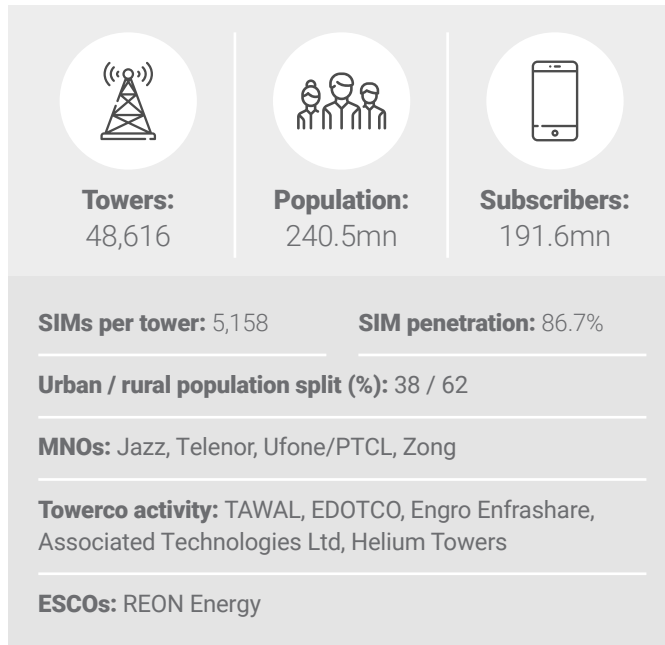
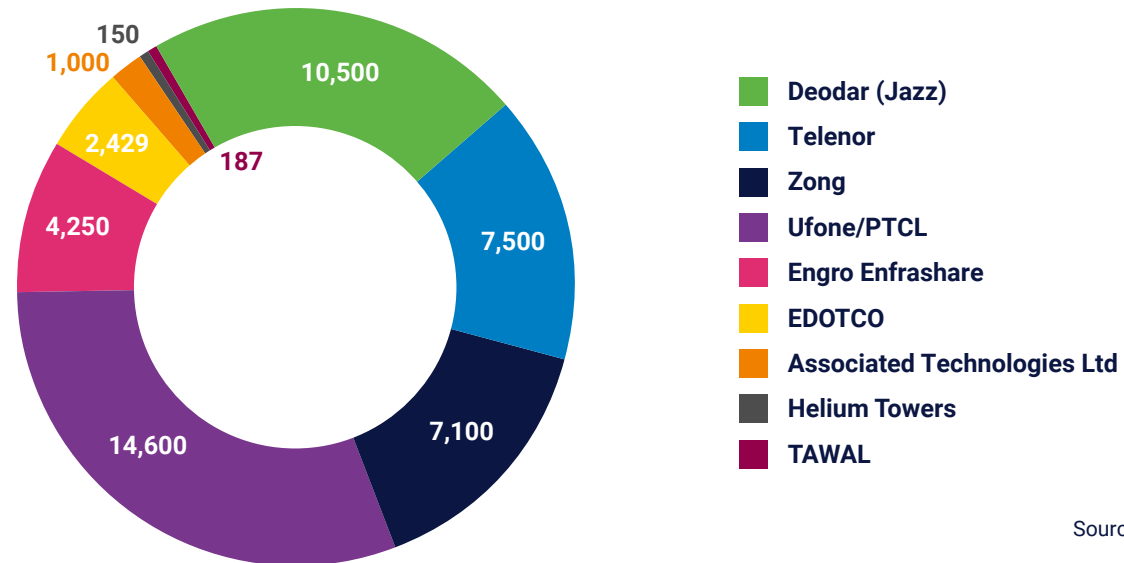


Figure 13: Pakistan – estimated tower count



Source: TowerXchange

Pakistan boasts one of the most competitive telecom markets in the region, with four MNOs vying for approximately 192 million subscribers. VEON's business unit, Jazz, leads the market with a 37.3% share, followed by Zong at 24.9%, Telenor at 23.6%, and Ufone at 13.3%. Intense competition among these operators has driven average revenue per user (ARPU) down to just US\$1, putting pressure on MNO revenues across the board.

PTCL, backed by e&, last year announced their acquisition of Telenor Pakistan, which had been planning an exit from the market. The deal is expected to help drive up ARPU, and there was speculation of either a full or partial tower sale of the combined 14,600 towers. However, Pakistan's antitrust regulator has recently completed its stage one review and found that PTCL would bolster its already strong position in the market and is concerned about rising prices and

a dip in service quality, with stage two of the analysis currently underway.

Data consumption has grown 4X in the last 5 years, and forecasted to growth 10% in the next 5, with 5G expecting to launch at the end of 2025 to 2026. The tower industry is expected to deliver another 10-15,000 tenancies over the next 5 years, with a greater emphasis on colocations over new builds as network coverage matures.



PAKISTAN

EDOTCO, Engro Enfrashare and Associated Technologies are the three major towercos. EDOTCO has been present in the market since 2014 before acquiring local towerco TowerShare in 2017. Market leader Engro Enfrashare was founded in 2018 as a subsidiary of national conglomerate Engro Corporation. ATL are an infrastructure development company active for over 30 years and now act as a towerco.

Helium Towers operates a small tower portfolio as well as fibre assets. TAWAL has acquired 100 sites from AWAL Telecom and has plans to grow in 2023, aiming to deliver over 500 new BTS sites deploy more than 30 new IBS and increase colocations. TowerXchange estimates the prevailing tenancy ratio to be around 1.25x in Pakistan, so increasing co-locations is an obvious opportunity.

After the latest round of bidding for Jazz's 10,500 tower unit Deodar failed to reach agreement, the deal has once again been shelves due to the macroeconomic situation in the market. A declining and unstable \$-PKR exchange rate made agreeing on a \$ valuation for the portfolio almost impossible.

The original deal between Jazz and EDOTCO was valued at US\$980mn 4-5 years ago, which in PKR would be worth half the amount of dollars it was back then.

Pakistan's volatile macroeconomic condition has made M&A activity challenging, but with the new

government expected to bring some level of stability and normalization following the end of import restrictions, the market may see an update in acquisitions. Deodar remains an unsold entity, and it is suggested that the Ufone-Telenor merger may lead to either a partial or staged sale of its tower infrastructure. E& Group also hinted a tower strategy at Meetup MENA 2024, although any official execution wouldn't be expected for the next 12-18 months.

As MNO consolidation has helped drive up ARPUs, towerco consolidation would help drive scale and reduce competition. EDOTCO has been focusing on its core Asian markets, while Engro Enfrashare has been exploring opportunities for expansion.

Pakistan is facing a great deal of macro-economic uncertainty. A foreign exchange reserve shortage saw the government temporarily ban imports for MNOs and towercos, slowing down network rollout. Although these bans are being lifted, equipment prices remain high and in short supply. An interest rate of 24% has also made raising capital extremely expensive.

The PKR has also been in a long decline due to market weakness and Pakistan is now on par with Nigeria in country risk, discouraging even emerging market investors. However, rising ARPUs and the injection of US dollars from an IMF finance program is reigniting MNO growth. To mitigate rising costs, towercos have raised their BTS prices 2X on top of a 5-6% YoY escalation. Add

to this power rates increasing 250% in the last 3-4 years and MNOs are seeing their profit margins squeezed.

In December 2024, Jazz, VEON's leading digital operator, formed a strategic partnership with Engro Connect, a subsidiary of Engro Corporation, marking a significant development in Pakistan's telecom sector. The agreement, formalised under a legal scheme, integrates Jazz's infrastructure arm, Deodar (Private) Limited, with Engro Connect to optimise telecom infrastructure across the country. Jazz will continue leasing Deodar's assets, essential for nationwide mobile services. This move aligns with Jazz's shift towards becoming a "Digital ServiceCo," focusing on fintech, entertainment, and cloud services, while reducing its asset base for greater efficiency. The deal also supports VEON's strategy of expanding into high-growth digital sectors. This collaboration highlights the increasing trend of infrastructure sharing in Pakistan's telecom sector, driving innovation and accelerating digital transformation.

5G is also becoming a priority for the new government and trials have been successfully conducted by all MNOs. The regulator is aiming at a spectrum auction to take place in early 2025 with a planned commercial launch in H2 2025 or early 2026. This will have a significant impact on tenancy ratios as MNOs densify their network coverage in urban hubs, but 5G network rollout will continue to remain a priority over the coming few years. While not a big commercial opportunity,



PAKISTAN

5G is also becoming a priority for the new government and trials have been successfully conducted by all MNOs. The regulator is aiming at a spectrum auction to take place in early 2025 with a planned commercial launch in H2 2025 or early 2026. This will have a significant impact on tenancy ratios as MNOs densify their network coverage in urban hubs, but 5G network rollout will continue to remain a priority over the coming few years. While not a big commercial opportunity, rural coverage requirements have mandated building in remote areas, supported by regulatory subsidies for passive and active CAPEX.

While energy costs are high, government policy subsidising solar equipment imports and cutting tax has created a huge drive for on-site renewable energy. Despite a 92% grid site availability, power outages are common outside major urban centres, and fuel prices have seen a 200% increase. MNOs are putting greater emphasis on towercos to manage power themselves, leading to the emergence of the ESCO model as some energy vendors are switching to providing full managed services.

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Qatar

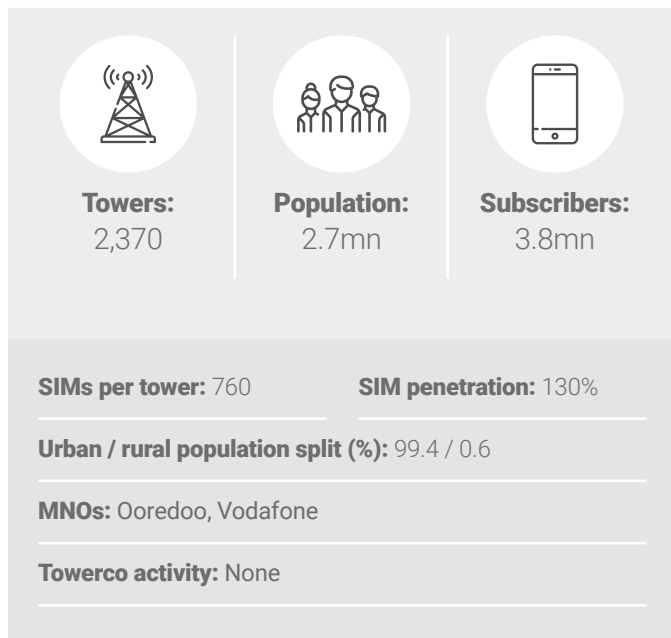
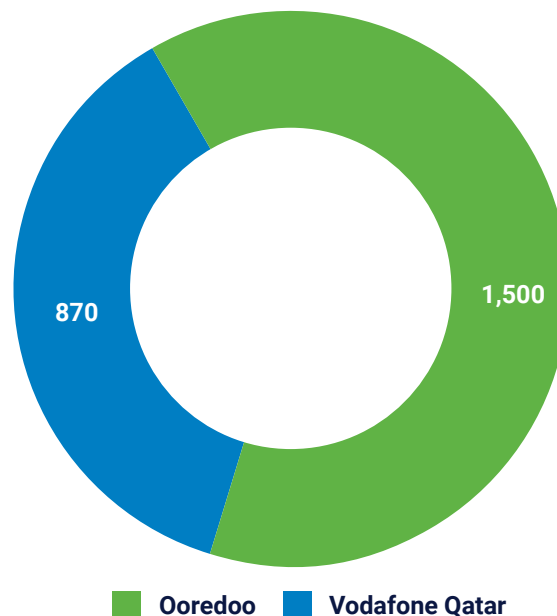


Figure 14: Qatar – estimated tower count



Source: TowerXchange

Qatar's economic growth has normalised over 2023 following the World Cup boom, with normalized growth expected in the near term supported by LNG production expansion and ongoing economic diversification initiatives.

Qatari headquartered Ooredoo are market leaders in their home country. Vodafone is the only other operator and sold its stake to former joint venture partner the Qatar Foundation back in 2018, although it continues to operate

under the Vodafone name. With only two operators in the market, it is hardly surprising that there is little infrastructure sharing.

Ooredoo's Qatari portfolio is part of the merger with Zain and TASC Towers, introducing the first towerco to the market. But with the country's small landmass, population

and MNO count there is limited long-term growth prospects for TASC. The current tenancy ratio of 1.15x is unlikely to grow significantly without a further acquisition of Vodafone Qatar's towers, allowing TASC to dismantle overlapping sites and run both MNOs networks on a single portfolio.

The early adoption of next generation technology makes Qatar an ideal market for digital ICT infrastructure and necessitates dense networks for high capacity 5G. Qatar has seen strong telecom market growth with an increasing urban population, high adoption of 3G,4G and 5G phones as well as an expanding IoT sector.

2G & 3G platforms are expected to close by 2025 with most mobile connections to be on 5G by 2029. This aligns with the government's Qatar National Vision 2023 to become a front-runner in 5G rollout, accelerating digital transformation and improving network infrastructure.

Ooredoo has deployed their first private LTE enterprise network for offshore oil-and-gas with Nokia, replacing the existing wifi network. Currently TASC is taking over macro towers and rooftops, but there is an opportunity to expand into non-macro infrastructure depending on regulation and appetite from Ooredoo.



QATAR

Ooredoo announced that it expects to close the Qatar portion of the deal's original within 18 months of the deal's announcement, or around June 2025, with the following countries to follow up to December 2025. The realities of the timelines may differ, but the announcement confirms TowerXchange's reporting that the unique deal is still progressing.



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Saudi Arabia

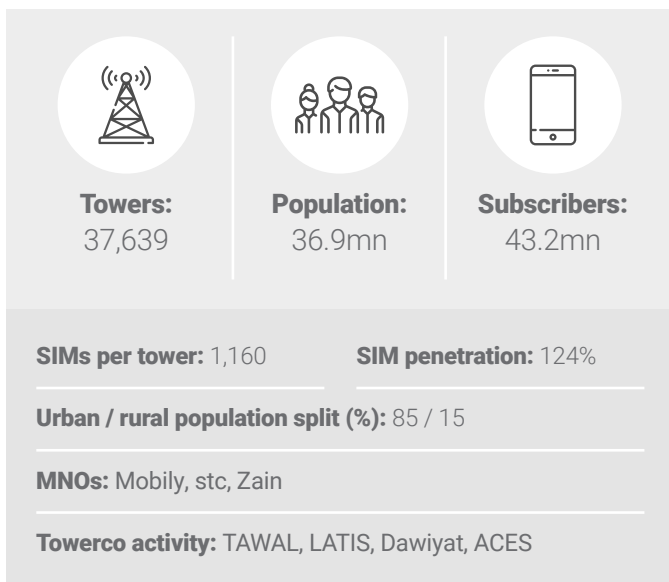
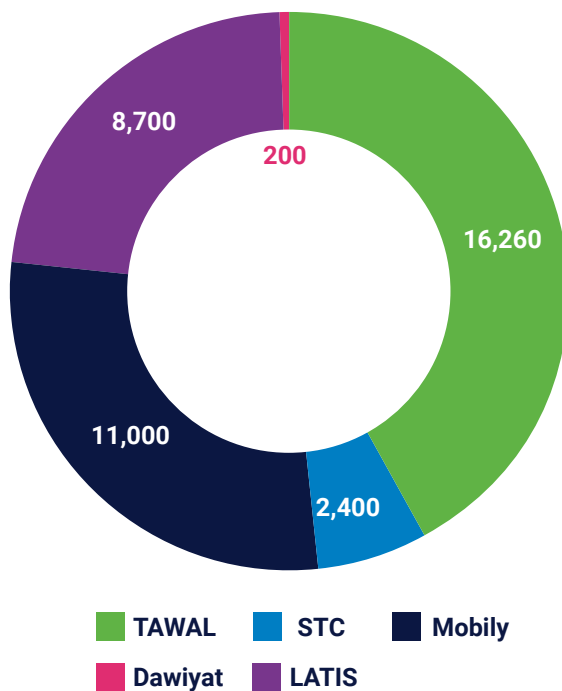


Figure 15: Saudi Arabia – estimated tower count



Source: TowerXchange

With minimal infrastructure sharing, a significant degree of parallel infrastructure has emerged, leading to around 95% site overlap between Zain and Mobily. As a result, the government is actively encouraging

infrastructure sharing to improve efficiency. STC Group's towerco, TAWAL, launched in 2019 as the first operator-owned towerco in the market, has gradually increased site colocations from 1.1 to 1.2x, with only 10% of sites shared. While Zain and Mobily were initially hesitant to collaborate on infrastructure, a 2020 agreement saw Mobily taking over 60-70% of their new builds, and a master service agreement (MSA) was signed with Zain at the end of 2021.

Zain KSA sold their 8,069 tower portfolio to The Kingdom's Public Investment Fund (PIF) for US\$805mn, which are being transferred to a new tower business unit Golden Latis Investment Company, or LATIS. The portfolio is around 60% macro towers and 40% rooftops sites, with plans to deliver around 2,500 greenfield build-to-suit over the next 10 years. The relatively low valuation of US\$100k per tower implies a modest lease rate for the operator. Zain received 2.4bn Riyals and a 20% stake in LATIS, but PIF has submitted an offer to acquire Zain KSAs remaining stake.

PIF has now acquired stc Group's 51% stake in TAWAL which has changed the towercos ownership structure from operator owned to a pureplay independent. Following this, PIF will consolidate both LATIS and TAWAL into a new single entity which will be 54%



SAUDI ARABIA

owned by PIF and 43.1% by stc Group, with LATIS minority shareholders owning the remaining issues share capital. This transaction is expected to complete in H2 2024, consolidating most of Saudi Arabia's towers into a new entity with a combined count of nearly 30,000 sites internationally.

Finally, Mobily has begun the process of telling its tower portfolio, engaging various consultancy firms to start structuring a deal. This is still in the very early stages and no further information has surfaced, but it can be assumed this will be the final step for TAWAL to consolidate the market.

The Kingdom is in the midst of an ambitious Vision 2030 project to modernise and diversify the economy, and digitization is a core component of this strategy. This is paying off, as investments in 5G are expected to contribute US\$18bn in GDP by 2030. With 60% 5G coverage, particularly in urban areas, and the development of numerous major megacity and smart city projects, network design is shifting from the macro layer to new coverage innovations. Zain is investing US\$47mn into 5G network expansion, increasing their points-of-presence to over 7,000, 66% of the Kingdom's population.

This growth in capacity is fuelling new site builds, with LATIS expecting to deploy 2-3,000 new sites and 1,000 of these complete by the end of 2024. Towercos positioning themselves as the leading provider of

connectivity infrastructure for megaprojects and smart cities is also leading to an uptake in new builds, not just macro towers but full end-to-end coverage solutions including modular small cells and street furniture. Edge data centres are being explored and there are expectations to see demand rise in the next 2-3 years.

TAWAL has an inbuilding solutions (IBS) license, targeting enterprise and smart city opportunities and has already deployed over 100 sites, becoming a big requirement from operators. TAWAL has also launched a modular small cell smart pole able to provide additional services such as EV charging, advertising space, CCTV cameras and drone docks to serve a broad array of customers beyond MNOs.

Most sites in urban areas are on-grid but rural sites still rely on diesel generators. TAWAL have around 2,000 sites still using generators, although 500 of these have been electrified since 2019. Sustainability is a priority for the Kingdom which has committed to reducing emissions by 25% by 2025. TAWAL recently released its first sustainability commitments and is looking to incorporate solar, rectifiers and battery backup with sustainable energy management systems.



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Tunisia

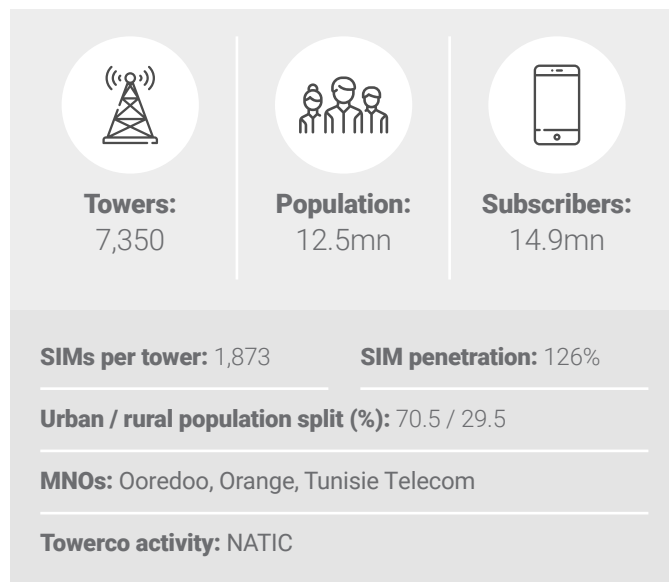
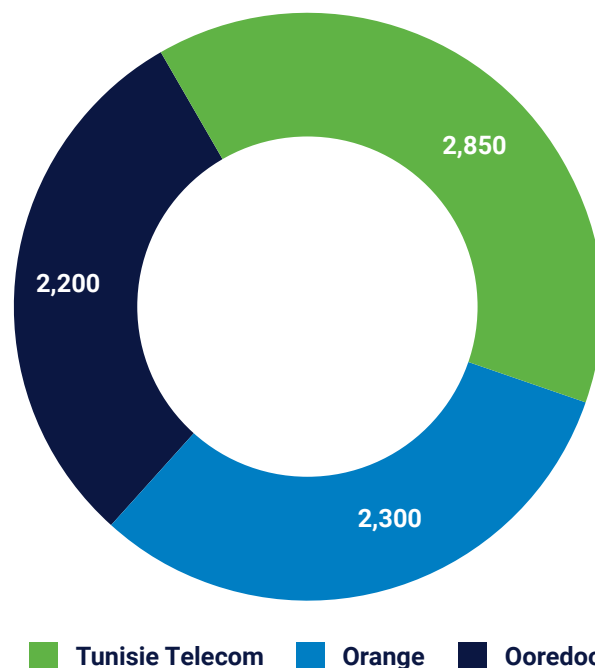


Figure 16: Tunisia – estimated tower count



Source: TowerXchange

8,000 sites are rooftops due to the concrete structures of most buildings with Tunisie Telecom having around 70% of its portfolio as rooftop sites. Tunisia is shaping up to be one of the most active tower markets in North Africa. Tunisie Telecom is in the process of carving out their 2,850 towers

into a separate entity. While the towerco will remain under Tunisie Telecom group, management and operations will be separated with future potential to either sell the portfolio or bring in a shareholding partner. Ooredoo's Tunisia portfolio is in the process of being transferred to TASC Towers as part of the merger between Ooredoo, Zain and TASC, and is waiting on regulatory approvals. With a tenancy ratio of 1.18x, there will be healthy opportunities for colocation as the first towerco to enter the market, and market consolidation via Tunisie Telecom is a possibility. Less so with Orange, after the group reaffirmed their commitment to retaining tower ownership early this year.

While there is no current regulation enforcing tower sharing, coverage commitments in 4G licenses require operators to provide certain coverage levels that have led to a limited number of site swaps on around 15% of sites. However, to protect market share, MNOs only share sites if their competitors use the same generation of network.

Tunisia is preparing to launch the country's first commercial 5G services next year and the ANRT has is in the process of setting out a clear roadmap. Minister Communication Technologies Nizar Ben Neji highlighted the importance of 5G to Tunisia's digital strategy, as the reduced latency and higher capacity will allow for the adoption of next-generation technologies to boost innovation and technological progress.



Towers:
13,000



Population:
9.5mn



Subscribers:
18.4mn

SIMs per tower: 1,415

SIM penetration: 186%

Urban / rural population split (%): 87.8 / 12.2

MNOs: du, Etisalat

Towerco activity: None



Etisalat leads the UAE's market where it competes with du (and MVNO Virgin Mobile). Emirates International Telecommunications is a shareholder in both du and Virgin Mobile in the country.

Whilst two competing entities, both Etisalat and du have a common shareholder in Emirates Investment Authority which has 60% share in the former and a 39.5% share in the latter which creates an unusual situation in the market.

The two operators have a fixed network sharing deal. There are an estimated 13,000 towers in the UAE of which Etisalat owns 8,000.

Both Etisalat and du have live 5G networks and are investing aggressively in new sites, with combined targets of nearly 1,000 new 5G sites in the Emirates.

E& claims to have made significant progress

towards becoming net-zero by 2030, accelerating the implementation of its climate action projects, including energy-efficient ratio equipment and AI to optimise power consumption.

The MNO has also heavily invested in converting indoor sites to outdoor free cooling systems and installing on-site solar hybrid power systems to replace diesel generators.

**Figure 18:** Major tower transactions in MENA since 2017

Year	Country	Seller	Buyer	Tower count	Deal value (\$)	Cost per tower (\$)	Deal structure
2024	Kuwait	IHS Towers	Zain	1,675	230,000,000	137,313	Buy out
2024	Pakistan	Jazz	Engro Connect	10,500	563,000,000	53619	Company acquisition
2024	Saudi Arabia	LATIS	TAWAL	24,516	Unknown	Unknown	Merger [7]
2024	Saudi Arabia	stc Group (TAWAL)	Public Infrastructure Fund	16,447	Unknown	Unknown	Company acquisition [6]
2023	Algeria, Iraq, Kuwait, Qatar, Tunisia	Ooredoo	TASC Towers	19,900	1,700,000,000	91,000	Merger [5]
2023	Iraq	Zain	TASC Towers	4,968	180,000,000	36,231	SLB [1] [3]
2022	Saudi Arabia	Zain	Latis	8,069	805,000,000	99,764	SLB
2022	Oman	Omantel	Helios Towers	2,519	495,000,000	196,506	SLB
2022	Pakistan	AWAL Towers	TAWAL	54	Unknown	Unknown	Company acquisition
2021	Jordan	Zain	TASC Towers	2,607	88,000,000	33,755	SLB [1] [2]
2021	Bahrain	Zain	TASC Towers	500	Unknown	Unknown	SLB (unclosed) [1]
2020	Israel	Communication Towers Israel	Tibar	63	Unknown	Unknown	Company acquisition [4]
2020	Kuwait	Zain	IHS Towers	1,620	130,000,000	80,247	SLB [1]
2017	Pakistan	Towershare	EDOTCO	700	Unknown	Unknown	Company acquisition

[1] Zain retains a minority stake in the subsidiary

[2] 525 BTS component included in deal

[3] 198 BTS component included in deal

[4] Continues to operate as Communications Towers under new management

[5] Ooredoo will receive a 49.3% stake in TASC + a cash payment from Zain to equalize their share value

[6] PIF acquired a 51% stake in TAWAL, transferring majority ownership from parent MNO stc Group who retains a 49% minority stake

[7] PIF is merging LATIS and TAWAL into a single entity, this process is still ongoing

